TECHNIQUES OF FOREIGN POLICY

DIPLOMACY

The coexistence of separate political units necessitates a certain degree of contact among them. There is a need for communication between governments, and the business of communicating between governments is technically termed as **diplomacy.** In the broadest sense, diplomacy is often used to mean both the making and execution of the foreign policy.

Diplomacy as an instrument of foreign policy is nothing new and can be traced to antiquity. Greece, Byzantium and Renaissance Italy made the most notable contributions to its evolution. But the origins of organized diplomacy dates back to the Congress of Vienna, 1815. The Congress of Vienna, The *Reglement* of 19 March 1815 and the subsequent regulations of Aix-la-Chappelle ultimately established the diplomatic services and representation of the powers on an agreed basis. Four categories of representatives were defined, namely: (a) ambassadors, papal legates and papal nuncios; (b) extraordinary envoys and plenipotentiary ministers; (c) ministers resident; (d) Chargè d'Affaires.[10] Finally, at the Vienna Conference on Diplomatic Intercourse and Immunities, attended by 81 states in 1961, a comprehensive agreement relating to almost all aspects of diplomatic practices was signed.

The Oxford Dictionary (Second edition, 1989) defines diplomacy as "the management of international relations by negotiation". Sir Ernest Satow (*Guide to Diplomatic Practice*, 1922) defined diplomacy as "the application of intelligence and tact to the conduct of official relations between governments of independent States". Another definition, which closely relates the method to the substance, is that diplomacy "represents the accumulative political, economic and military pressures upon each side formalized in the exchange of demands and concessions between negotiators".[11]

Nicolson[12] gives five different meanings of diplomacy. He says that in current language diplomacy is carelessly taken to denote several things. Diplomacy is taken as: